

The negotiations are over.... each student is now required to write an **individual** reflective report which discusses some of the key issues they encountered during their playing of the negotiation game. Students are encouraged to **reflect** on their experiences and identify activities and actions associated with a successful negotiation outcome.

In doing so it is expected that you discuss some of the problems that arose, what actions were taken, and why and how solutions were found, and how you might approach the situation differently in future. Particularly the final phase of the process. Where possible, you should draw on the negotiation literature and attempt to **connect** your experiences to theory. It is expected that you display background reading.

Students are strongly advised to make use of any notes/diary they made during the game playing, either individually or as a group, and listen to the audio recording of the final negotiation.

You must choose **two topics** to reflect on.

- One topic from **List A**
- One topic from **List B**

List A – Late Changes

- A1 If you were part of a **CCG** team; how did you approach the allocation of the **additional funds** that were made available prior to the final negotiation?
How did you investigate the options available to you at the hospitals?
Use the voice recorder evidence¹ to support this discussion, if relevant.
- A2 If you were part of an **Avondale** team; how did you go about securing a portion of the additional funds to support the **expansion** of your hospital?
What persuasion techniques and/or pricing strategies did you use?
Use the voice recorder evidence¹ to support this discussion, if relevant.
- A3 If you were part of a **Bridge** team; how did you go about securing a portion of the additional funds to support the **expansion** of your hospital?
What persuasion techniques and/or pricing strategies did you use?
Use the voice recorder evidence¹ to support this discussion, if relevant.

List B – Game Specific

- B1 How did you handle the idea of **fairness** and/or **equality**, in terms episodes, expansion and funding¹?
- B2 The role of **proposals** and how they shaped the deal, with examples¹.
- B3 How your **personality** and the personalities of others in your game, influenced the game and outcome¹
- B4 A critical assessment of the strengths, weaknesses and limitations of the **DSS model**
- B5 A critical assessment of the strengths, weaknesses and limitations of the **Crossbay Negotiation Game**
- B6 A discussion of **business games** for learning skills and the implications for the Crossbay Game
- B7 **Persuasion techniques** – how you use language and body language to influence someone

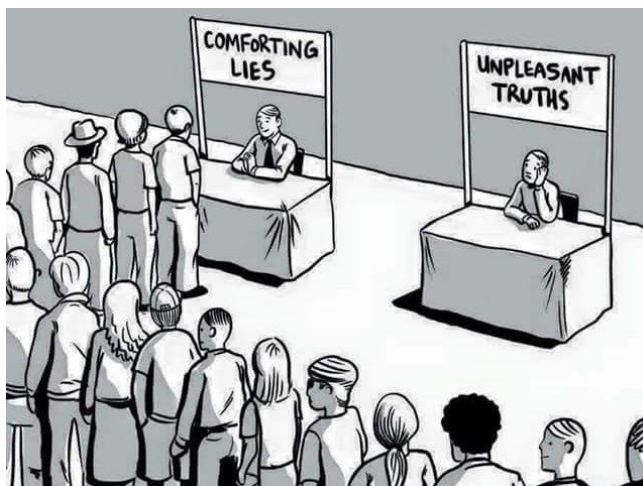
If you want to reflect on a topic that is **not** listed, or you wish to write the reflection based on a **single** topic, then you **must** discuss this with Adam beforehand and be given the go-ahead to use the new topic.

Regarding the reflection itself, **do not write just a story** or narrative about what happened. It needs to be a critical analysis and reflection of the different issues and incidents, with your own ideas and opinions. Marks will be assigned for demonstrating that you have attempted to **make sense** of the experience, generated **insight** into the dynamics of negotiation, have connected your experiences to some **theory**.

There are no issues/topics/perspectives that are outside the scope of this reflection – you can discuss theory relating to negotiation, project management, psychology, sociology, parenting and beyond.

¹ if you refer to a section of voice recording, then note the **timecode** of that section and include any **quotes in italics**

We are happy for you to discuss work with one another, but we will check for copying. The document will be scanned by Turnitin for plagiarism. All the written work must be your own.



"We won because we were better prepared and more committed than they were"

[internal LOC]

"We lost because of poor refereeing, bad luck and a few key decisions went against us"

[external LOC]

"Even though we lost, I still think we played the better football"

[confirmation bias]

"To be honest, I wasn't that bothered about winning anyway"

[cognitive dissonance]

All lies and jest

Still, a man hears what he wants to hear

And disregards the rest

Simon and Garfunkel, The Boxer

[confirmation bias]

Psychologists have long identified that the way we perceive events is biased and depends on whether the outcome is positive or negative. Positive outcomes tend to be attributed *internally*, to our own skills and capabilities, whereas negative outcomes tend to be attributed to *external* factors. In other words, when it goes wrong you look to blame someone, or something, else. This idea is called **Locus of Control [LOC]**. There is also a link between locus of control and deceptive behaviours, when individuals justify deception due to external factors.

You are encouraged to take **responsibility** for what happened. If your poor performance was due to low levels of effort, commitment and/or preparation, then you must reflect on *why* you didn't put the effort in and why you didn't try to succeed in the game. Did you think it would be easy? Are you afraid to try and fail? Did you 'settle'? Consider some background reading on the concept of **anti-fragility**.

This links to a second psychological bias, that of **Confirmation Bias**. This is where you pick evidence that suits your position and ignore/undervalue/dismiss anything that might contradict it. It's easy to confirm your position/attitude/belief, if you never let anything in that would undermine it.

A third psychological mechanism that may be relevant relates to deception, and the tendency to *think* in one way then *act* in an opposing way. This is called **Cognitive Dissonance**. An example of this might be to say you want an 'open and honest' dialogue but then introduce misinformation into the game and act deceptively. Another example would be to say you want 'collaborate' then behave in your own self-interest. These are **not compatible** positions. People who experience dissonance often try to justify it with unusual or irrational reasons or 'cherry pick' the evidence to suit their position (again, confirmation bias).

When reflecting on the events in the game – and trying to learn from it – it is essential that you are honest, open-minded, robust, creative and **insightful** about the *real* reasons behind the way things turned out the way they did. That's not to say that luck doesn't play a part.... but there is **good** luck as well as **bad**.

- The word limit is 1600 words (+/- 10%). Include your word count.
- The format and structure of the report is not fixed. It is entirely up to the author of the report.
- Ensure you include the numbers for each topic; A1 or B3 etc.
- Negotiation events should be written in the first person – e.g. “I felt at the time that he wasn’t to be trusted”
- Include at the start of the report your favourite *negotiation-related quote* which captures a key feature of the Crossbay game
- Due date is the **5th May**

My feedback comments will attempt to ‘group’ the feedback into the following areas, with all sections equally weighted.

However, **do not** structure your report with these sub-headings.

Marker’s Comments for Students:

Identifying anecdotes and key issues

Discuss problems and solutions – sense making

Identify actions for improvement – learning

Critical analysis and references to theory

Good negotiation practice and audio references